

CS 601.471/671 NLP: Self-supervised Models

Homework 6: Adapting Transformers Language Models for Your Problems

For homework deadline and collaboration policy, check the calendar on the course website*

Name: _____

Collaborators, if any: _____

Sources used for your homework, if any: _____

This assignment will return to basics of Transformers and dig deeper into the fundamental concepts. Additionally, we will get our hands dirty by fine-tuning Transformer language models and comparing their performance. We will also be working more closely with GPU processors on our cluster and using them with Slurm queuing system. Isn't that awesome? We tend to think it is! :)

Homework goals: After completing this homework, you should be comfortable with:

- Training a pre-trained Language Model for your tasks
- You will explore different variations of model training
- You will compare the above results with few-shot prompting of models.

How to hand in your written work: via Gradescope.

Collaboration: You can do this homework as a team of 2 people. Basically, you can write a single solution for both people and upload it as a single PDF and a single .zip file as a group.

Typesetting: We strongly recommend typesetting your homework, especially if you have sloppy handwriting! :) We will provide a LaTeX template for homework solutions.

*<https://self-supervised.cs.jhu.edu/sp2025/>

1 Concepts, intuitions and big picture

1. How does the BERT model expect a pair of sentences to be processed?

- ☐ Tokens-of-sentence-1 [SEP] Tokens-of-sentence-2
- ☐ [CLS] Tokens-of-sentence-1 Tokens-of-sentence-2
- ☐ [CLS] Tokens-of-sentence-1 [SEP] Tokens-of-sentence-2

Answer: 3rd

2. When should you train a new tokenizer?

- ☐ When your dataset is similar to that used by an existing pretrained model, and you want to pretrain a new model
- ☐ When your dataset is similar to that used by an existing pretrained model, and you want to fine-tune a new model using this pretrained model
- ☐ When your dataset is different from the one used by an existing pretrained model, and you want to pretrain a new model

Answer: 3rd

3. Select the sentences that apply to the BPE model of tokenization.

- ☐ BPE is a subword tokenization algorithm that starts with a small vocabulary and learns merge rules.
- ☐ BPE is a subword tokenization algorithm that starts with a big vocabulary and progressively removes tokens from it.
- ☐ BPE tokenizers learn merge rules by merging the pair of tokens that is the most frequent.
- ☐ A BPE tokenizer learns a merge rule by merging the pair of tokens that maximizes a score that privileges frequent pairs with less frequent individual parts.
- ☐ BPE tokenizes words into subwords by splitting them into characters and then applying the merge rules.
- ☐ BPE tokenizes words into subwords by finding the longest subword starting from the beginning that is in the vocabulary, then repeating the process for the rest of the text.

Answer: 1, 3, 5

4. What are the labels in a masked language modeling problem?

- ☐ Some of the tokens in the input sentence are randomly masked and the labels are the original input tokens.
- ☐ Some of the tokens in the input sentence are randomly masked and the labels are the original input tokens, shifted to the left.
- ☐ Some of the tokens in the input sentence are randomly masked, and the label is whether the sentence is positive or negative.
- ☐ Some of the tokens in the two input sentences are randomly masked, and the label is whether the two sentences are similar or not.

Answer: 1st one

5. When should you pretrain a new model?

- ☐ When there is no pretrained model available for your specific language
- ☐ When you have lots of data available, even if there is a pretrained model that could work on it
- ☐ When you have concerns about the bias of the pretrained model you are using

Answer: 1, 3rd

6. Is there something wrong with the following code?

```
from transformers import AutoTokenizer, AutoModel

tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("bert-base-cased")
model = AutoModel.from_pretrained("gpt2")

encoded = tokenizer("Hey!", return_tensors="pt")
result = model(**encoded)
```

- ☐ No, it seems correct.
- ☐ The tokenizer and model should always be from the same checkpoint.
- ☐ It's good practice to pad and truncate with the tokenizer as every input is a batch.

Homework 6, oh how you test my skill,
Fine-tuning Transformers, it's a daunting thrill,
BERT, T5, and GPT, they all await,
To see if I can prompt them to create.

First, I must understand their inner workings,
And how to train them to do my biddings,
I tweak and tune their parameters with care,
Hoping my models will be beyond compare.

With each iteration, my models learn and grow,
Their predictions becoming more accurate, I know,
But there's still work to be done, and prompts to write,
To make sure they generate what's right.

I craft my prompts with precision and care,
To guide my models and make them aware,
Of the context and task at hand,
Hoping they'll produce output that's grand.

Homework 6, you pushed me to my limit,
But in the end, I'm glad I did it,
For now I understand these Transformers so well,
And know how to prompt them to excel.
-ChatGPT March 3 2023

Answer: The 2nd one.

7. Select the sentences that are CORRECT about the Transformer model:

- ☐ All variants of Transformers captures information bidirectionally. i.e. Each token attends to every other token during training.
- ☐ During inference of a Decoder-only Transformer, because you need to concatenate the generation of the previous timestep to the current prefix, you need to perform the full-forward pass of the Transformer multiple times in order to generate a full sentence.
- ☐ During standard training of a decoder-only transformer, you are always using “teacher-forcing”. That is, you are always appending the ground truth next token to the current prefix, then making a prediction, and then calculating the loss between your prediction and the next ground truth.
- ☐ For generating text from a decoder-only transformer and an RNN of the same size, the transformer is faster due to being able to parallelize the computations.

Answer: 2nd one and the 3rd one

8. Select the sentences that are CORRECT about Normalization in Transformers:

- ☐ Layer Normalization re-centers and re-scales the activations, therefore it does not contain trainable parameters.
- ☐ Layer Normalization performs normalization between different layers of the model. It reduces the variance between the activations of different layers.
- ☐ The reason why it does not make sense to perform batch normalization when training transformers is that when training language models, the batches are too large.
- ☐ None of the above is correct.

Answer: The 4th one.

2 Getting Your Attention with Self-Attention

Recall that the transformer architecture uses scaled dot-product attention to compute *attention weights*:

$$\alpha^{(t)} = \text{softmax} \left(\frac{\mathbf{q}_t \mathbf{K}^\top}{\sqrt{h}} \right) \in [0, 1]^n$$

The resulting embedding in the output of attention at position t are:

$$\text{Attention}(\mathbf{Q}, \mathbf{K}, \mathbf{V})_t = \sum_{t'=1}^n \alpha_{t'}^{(t)} \mathbf{v}_{t'} \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times h},$$

where $\alpha^{(t)} = [\alpha_0^{(t)}, \dots, \alpha_n^{(t)}]$. The same idea can be stated in a matrix form,

$$\text{Attention}(\mathbf{Q}, \mathbf{K}, \mathbf{V}) = \text{softmax} \left(\frac{\mathbf{Q} \mathbf{K}^\top}{\sqrt{h}} \right) \mathbf{V} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times h}.$$

In the above equations:

- h is the hidden state dimension and n is the input sequence length;
- $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times h}$ is the input to the attention;
- $\mathbf{x}_t \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times h}$ is the slice of $\mathbf{X}$ at position t , i.e. vector representation (embedding) of the input token at position t ;
- $\mathbf{W}_q, \mathbf{W}_k, \mathbf{W}_v \in \mathbb{R}^{h \times h}$ are the projection matrices to build query, key and value representations;
- $\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{X} \mathbf{W}_q \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times h}, \mathbf{K} = \mathbf{X} \mathbf{W}_k \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times h}, \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{X} \mathbf{W}_v \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times h}$ are the query, key and value representations;
- $\mathbf{q}_t = \mathbf{x}_t \mathbf{W}_q \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times h}$ is the slice of $\mathbf{Q}$ at position t . Similarly, $\mathbf{k}_t = \mathbf{x}_t \mathbf{W}_k \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times h}$ and $\mathbf{v}_t = \mathbf{x}_t \mathbf{W}_v \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times h}$.

2.1 Forget 'Softmax', 'Argmax' is the New Boss in Town!

Recall from lectures that we can think about attention as being queryable softmax pooling. In this problem, we ask you to consider a hypothetical 'argmax' version of attention where it returns exactly the value corresponding to the key that is most similar to the query, where similarity is measured using the traditional inner-product. In other words, here use a version of Attention that instead of using softmax we use argmax to generate outputs from the attention layer. For example, $\text{softmax}([1, 3, 2])$ becomes $\text{argmax}([1, 3, 2]) = [0, 1, 0]$.

1. Perform argmax attention with the following keys and values:

$$\text{Keys} = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \\ -2 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -1 \\ -2 \end{bmatrix} \right\}, \text{Values} = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ -4 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ -2 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

using the following query:

$$\mathbf{q} = \begin{bmatrix} -2 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

What would be the output of the attention layer for this query? Remember, to simplify calculations, use an argmax instead of softmax. Note about notation: each vector in 'Keys = {·}' and 'Values{·}' are key/value vectors corresponding to four, non-interchangeable positions (i.e., ordering of these vectors matter).

Answer:

$$\mathbf{qK}^T = \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 2 & -2 & -2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 & 1 & -3 \end{bmatrix}$$

As $h > 0$,

$$\text{argmax}\left(\frac{\mathbf{q}^T \mathbf{K}}{\sqrt{h}}\right) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

and so

$$\text{argmax}\left(\frac{\mathbf{q}^T \mathbf{K}}{\sqrt{h}}\right) \mathbf{V} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 & -4 \\ 3 & -2 & 4 \\ 3 & 2 & 0 \\ 3 & 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 & -4 \end{bmatrix}$$

2. How does this design choice affect our ability to usefully train models involving attention? (**Hint:** think about how the gradients flow through the network in the backward pass. Can we learn to improve our queries or keys during the training process?)

Answer: argmax is not differentiable, so we cannot backpropagate gradients

2.2 Superposition of Information in Self-Attention

We will show that the attention mechanism is able to copy the information from its input, whenever needed.*

1. **'Copying' mechanism in self-attention:** We'll first show that it is particularly simple for attention to "copy" a value vector to the output. Describe (in 1-2 sentences) what properties of the inputs to the attention operation would result in the output $\text{Attention}(\mathbf{Q}, \mathbf{K}, \mathbf{V})_t$ being approximately equal to $\mathbf{v}_j$ for some $j \in [0 \dots n]$.

Hint: Show that there can exist $j \in [0 \dots n]$ such that $\alpha_j^{(t)} \gg \sum_{i \neq j} \alpha_i^{(t)}$, if certain property holds for the query $\mathbf{q}_t$, and the keys $\{\mathbf{k}_0 \dots \mathbf{k}_n\}$.

Answer: if the query vector $\mathbf{q}_t$ and the key vectors $\{\mathbf{k}_0 \dots \mathbf{k}_n\}$ satisfies that

$$\mathbf{q}_t \mathbf{k}_j \gg \mathbf{q}_t \mathbf{k}_i, \forall i \neq j$$

After softmax, we would have

$$\alpha_j^{(t)} \gg \sum_{i \neq j} \alpha_i^{(t)}$$

*Question credit: John Hewitt

Which means

$$\alpha_j^{(t)} \approx 1, \alpha_i^{(t)} \approx 0, \forall i \neq j$$

Therefore, the attention operation is equivalent to copying the j th value vector.

2. **Extracting signals after averaging them:** Instead of focusing on just one vector $\mathbf{v}_j$, attention mechanism might want to incorporate information from multiple source vectors. Consider the case where we instead want to incorporate information from two vectors $\mathbf{v}_a$ and $\mathbf{v}_b$, with corresponding key vectors $\mathbf{k}_a$ and $\mathbf{k}_b$. How should we combine information from two value vectors $\mathbf{v}_a$ and $\mathbf{v}_b$? A common way to combine values vectors is to average them: $\bar{\mathbf{v}} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{v}_a + \mathbf{v}_b)$. However, after such averaging it is not quite clear how to tease apart the original information in value vectors $\mathbf{v}_a$ and $\mathbf{v}_b$. Unless ... some special properties hold!

Suppose that although we don't know $\mathbf{v}_a$ or $\mathbf{v}_b$, we do know that $\mathbf{v}_a$ lies in a subspace[†] A formed by the m basis vectors[‡] $\{\mathbf{a}_1, \mathbf{a}_2, \dots, \mathbf{a}_m\}$, while $\mathbf{v}_b$ lies in a subspace B formed by the p basis vectors $\{\mathbf{b}_1, \mathbf{b}_2, \dots, \mathbf{b}_p\}$. This means that any $\mathbf{v}_a$ can be expressed as a linear combination of its basis vectors, as can $\mathbf{v}_b$. All basis vectors have norm 1 and are orthogonal to each other. Additionally, suppose that the two subspaces are orthogonal; i.e. $\mathbf{a}_j^\top \mathbf{b}_k = 0$ for all j, k . Using the basis vectors $\{\mathbf{a}_1, \mathbf{a}_2, \dots, \mathbf{a}_m\}$, construct a matrix M such that for arbitrary vectors $\mathbf{v}_a \in A$ and $\mathbf{v}_b \in B$, we can use M to extract $\mathbf{v}_a$ from the average vector $\bar{\mathbf{v}}$. In other words, we want to construct M such that for any $\mathbf{v}_a, \mathbf{v}_b$, $M\bar{\mathbf{v}} = \mathbf{v}_a$. Show that $M\bar{\mathbf{v}} = \mathbf{v}_a$ holds for your M .

Answer: Given $\mathbf{v}_a = \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \mathbf{a}_i$, we have that

$$\mathbf{a}_j^\top \mathbf{v}_a = \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \mathbf{a}_j^\top \mathbf{a}_i = c_j$$

Furthermore, $\mathbf{a}_j \cdot (\mathbf{a}_j^\top \mathbf{v}_a) = c_j \mathbf{a}_j$, we can argue that

$$\left(\sum_{j=1}^n \mathbf{a}_j \mathbf{a}_j^\top \right) \mathbf{v}_a = \mathbf{v}_a$$

Since $\mathbf{a}_k$ are all orthogonal to $\mathbf{b}_k$, we see that

$$\left(\sum_{j=1}^n \mathbf{a}_j \mathbf{a}_j^\top \right) \cdot (\mathbf{v}_a + \mathbf{v}_b) = \mathbf{v}_a$$

We see that $2 \sum_{j=1}^n \mathbf{a}_j \mathbf{a}_j^\top$ satisfies the requirement for M .

3. **Averaging pairs of representations:** As before, let $\mathbf{v}_a$ and $\mathbf{v}_b$ be two value vectors corresponding to key vectors $\mathbf{k}_a$ and $\mathbf{k}_b$, respectively. Assume that (1) all key vectors are orthogonal, so $\mathbf{k}_i^\top \mathbf{k}_j = 0$ for all $i \neq j$; and (2) all key vectors have norm 1. Find an expression for a query vector $\mathbf{q}_t$ such that $\text{Attention}(\mathbf{Q}, \mathbf{K}, \mathbf{V})_t = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{v}_a + \mathbf{v}_b)$ and justify your answer.

Answer: $\mathbf{q}_t = \mathbf{k}_a + \mathbf{k}_b - m \sum_{j \notin \{a, b\}} \mathbf{k}_j$, where m is a super large number. this way only $\mathbf{q}_t^\top \mathbf{k}_a = \mathbf{q}_t^\top \mathbf{k}_b = 1$, else $\mathbf{q}_t^\top \mathbf{k} = -m$.

2.3 Extra Credit: Importance of 'Scaling' in Self-Attention

In practice, we scale each dot product $\mathbf{QK}^\top$ by a factor of $\sqrt{h}$. This is called *scaled dot product attention*. In this part, we will prove why we perform this scaling. Suppose we are performing a dot product between a key $\mathbf{k}$ and query $\mathbf{q}$, where $\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{q} \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times h}$ and $\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{q} \sim \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}, \sigma^2 \mathbf{I})$. You can assume that $\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{q}$ are sampled independently.

- (a) Compute $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{qk}^\top]$ in terms of $\boldsymbol{\mu}, h, \sigma$.

Answer: If X, Y are independent of one another, $\mathbb{E}[XY] = \mathbb{E}[X]\mathbb{E}[Y]$. Therefore,

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{qk}^\top] = \boldsymbol{\mu}\boldsymbol{\mu}^\top$$

[†]https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Linear_subspace

[‡][https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Basis_\(linear_algebra\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Basis_(linear_algebra))

(b) Compute $\text{Var}[\mathbf{qk}^\top]$ in terms of μ, h, σ .

Answer:

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Var}[\mathbf{qk}^\top] &= \mathbf{E}[(\mathbf{qk}^\top - \mathbf{E}[\mathbf{qk}^\top])^2] \\
&= \mathbf{E}[(\mathbf{qk}^\top)^2] - (\mathbf{E}[\mathbf{qk}^\top])^2 \\
&= \mathbf{E} \left[\left(\sum_{i=1}^h q_i k_i \right)^2 \right] - \left(\mathbf{E} \left[\sum_{i=1}^h q_i k_i \right] \right)^2 \\
&= \mathbf{E} \left[\sum_{i=1}^h \sum_{j=1}^h q_i q_j k_i k_j \right] - \left(\sum_{i=1}^h \mathbf{E}[q_i k_i] \right)^2 \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^h \sum_{j=1}^h \mathbf{E}[q_i q_j] \mathbf{E}[k_i k_j] - \left(\sum_{i=1}^h \mathbf{E}[q_i] \mathbf{E}[k_i] \right)^2 \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^h \mathbf{E}[q_i^2] \mathbf{E}[k_i^2] + \sum_{i=1}^h \sum_{j \neq i} \mathbf{E}[q_i q_j] \mathbf{E}[k_i k_j] - \left(\sum_{i=1}^h \mathbf{E}[q_i] \mathbf{E}[k_i] \right)^2 \\
&= \sum_{i=0}^h (\sigma^2 + \mu_i^2)^2 + \sum_{i=1}^h \sum_{j \neq i} (\mu_i \mu_j)^2 - \left(\sum_{i=1}^h \mathbf{E}[q_i] \mathbf{E}[k_i] \right)^2 \\
&= h(\sigma^2 + \mu^2)^2 + h(h-1)\mu^4 - h^2\mu^4 \\
&= h\sigma^4 \text{ (if } \mu = 0)
\end{aligned}$$

(c) Based on the variance computed above and assuming that $\mu = 0$ and $\sigma = 1$, explain why we need to scale the dot product by $\sqrt{h}$. Explain why this scaling is important for numerical stability.

Answer: Currently the variance is biased by h - scaling removes this bias.

3 Programming

In this programming homework, we will finetune encoder LMs for a classification task with yes/no questions. In particular, we will

- Implement full-parameter finetuning.
- Explore various parameter-efficient finetuning strategies.

Additionally, we will also experiment with in-context learning using GPT-3.5 models via OpenAI APIs.

Skeleton Code and Structure: The code base for this homework can be found at [this GitHub repo](#) under the hw6 directory. Your task is to fill in the missing parts in the skeleton code, following the requirements, guidance, and tips provided in this pdf and the comments in the corresponding .py files. The code base has the following structure:

- `base_classification.py`: implements the basic full finetuning
- `classification.py`: implements different parameter-efficient finetuning

TODOs — Your tasks include 1) generate plots and/or write short answers based on the results of running the code; 2) fill in the blanks in the skeleton to complete the code. We will explicitly mark these plotting, written answer, and filling-in-the-blank tasks as **TODOs** in the following descriptions, as well as a `# TODO` at the corresponding blank in the code.

Submission: Your submission should contain two parts: 1) plots and short answers under the corresponding questions below; and 2) your completion of the skeleton code base, in a .zip file, which includes the two provided skeleton files and a `openai_gpt-boolq.py` script you created (details in [subsection 3.3](#)).

Overview and Dataset In this programming assignment, you will get your hands dirtier with building self-supervised models. You will build a classifier using the Huggingface Transformer library and PyTorch. This classifier is expected to solve the BoolQ dataset [[Clark et al., 2019](#)]. You can find this dataset on Huggingface’s dataset hub: <https://huggingface.co/datasets/boolq>. In this task, each input consists of a question statement and a passage that may contain the answer to this question. The output is the answer to the question which may be one of ‘Yes’ or ‘No’ labels. Here is an example:

```
{
  "passage": "\"All biomass goes through at least some of these steps: it needs to be grown,
                                                    collected, dried, fermented, distilled,
                                                    and burned...\"",
  "question": "does ethanol take more energy make that produces"
  "answer": false,
}
```

The data comes with training and validation subsets. We will select a subset of the training data as ‘test’ set. So for the main experiments we will use 8k instances for training and the rest for testing.

sbatch Scripts You can create your own sbatch scripts for the following **TODOs** whenever you need to run GPU jobs on the Rockfish. You can use the `sbatch.sh` in homework 5 as a reference.

Python Scripts Arguments Many of the **TODOs** below involves setting different training configurations and hyper-parameters, this could be achieved through the arguments provided in `main` of both `base_classification.py` and `classification.py` - they should be self-explanatory.

General Hint Follow the specifications and requirements in the code comments to complete missing lines.

3.1 Finetuning: Basics

- (a) Let's start with the basic full finetuning, where all the parameters will be updated during the training. Specifically, we will use `AutoModelForSequenceClassification` which implements a classifier that maps the representation of encoder LMs (BERT, RoBERTa, etc.) into a fixed set of labels. Use this class to build a binary classifier using the representations of `distilbert-base-uncased` [Sanh et al., 2019]. The starter code for full finetuning in `base_classification.py` has a bunch of basic functionalities implemented, but it is missing details.

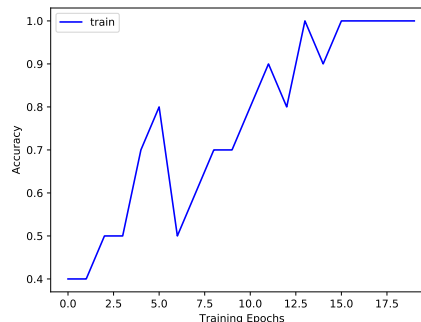
TODOs: Read and complete the missing lines in `evaluate_model` and `train` functions in `base_classification.py` to complete the functionalities of full finetuning.

To make sure your implementation is correct, we can train the model on 10 training instances for a few epochs (say, a total of 20 epochs). Note that over-fitting a few training examples is a good first test to make sure your implementation can successfully learn the patterns of your data. You should be able to complete the starter code and run it on a few instances in your local machine. You should be able to see that your classifier successfully over-fits its few training examples.

TODOs: Run `base_classification.py` with the following command on your local machine, paste the generated plot of training accuracy vs. epochs plots below.

```
> python base_classification.py --small_subset --device cuda --model "distilbert-base-uncased" --batch_size "64" --lr 1e-4 --num_epochs 20
```

your plot



- (b) Now, rather than running training on a subset of the data, try training with all the data on Rockfish. Make sure to find the largest batch size that can fit in the Rockfish GPUs. You can start with a reasonable number, say 32. If it fits, double it to 64. If it does not fit, halve the value to 16.

TODOs Train for 30 epochs and paste the generated plot of train and dev accuracies vs. epochs below. Also report the largest batch size.

Hint: You should see that training accuracy goes high, while the dev accuracy will go high and then turn downhill as the model overfits the data.

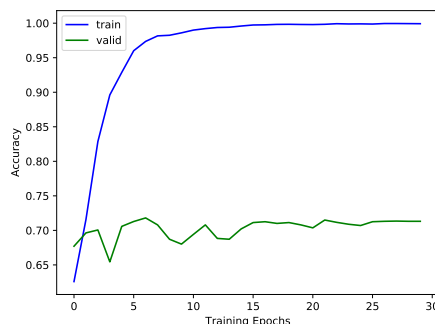
your plot

Answer: *The largest batch size: 64*

- (c) Let's implement hyper-parameter selection by exploring the combination of different hyper-parameter choices.

TODOs: Train models for various choices of learning rates ($1e-4$, $5e-4$, $1e-3$) and training epochs (7, 9). Select the model with the highest accuracy on the dev set and report its accuracy on the test set. Also report the corresponding choice of hyperparameters

Answer:

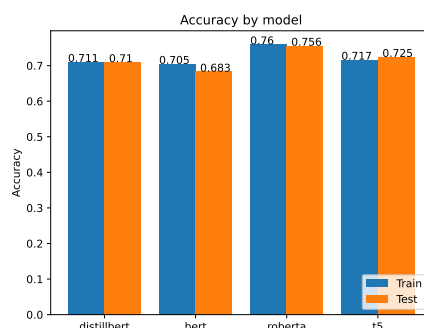


Best accuracy of distilBERT-base-uncased on the dev set: 0.710703363914373
 Best accuracy of distilBERT-base-uncased on the test set: 0.709880868955515

Learning rate:
 Training epochs:

- (d) **TODOs** Now repeat the previous experiment with other models. In particular, create a **bar plot** that shows test/dev accuracies for two of your favorite of the following models: distilBERT-base-uncased, BERT-base-uncased, BERT-large-uncased, BERT-base-cased, BERT-large-cased, RoBERTa-base, RoBERTa-large. Note, it is possible that some of these models wouldn't fit in Rockfish GPUs for any choice of batch size, in which case report 0 for their performance.

your plot



3.2 Parameter-Efficient Fine-Tuning

In this section, we will implement two more efficient ways of tuning language models: **Head-Tuning**, which freezes all parameters but the classification head, and **Prefix-Tuning**, which also freezes all parameters but the classification head, and additionally appends a fixed length ℓ of trainable embeddings to the input embeddings. See figure 1 for an illustration of which parameters are getting updated in each fine-tuning method we will explore in this homework.

Note that "output features" tensor for a single sequence of input should be of shape (length, hidden size), or equivalently $\mathbb{R}^{N \times d}$. However, the classifier expects a tensor of shape $\mathbb{R}^{1 \times d}$. There are multiple ways to transform the output features to $\mathbb{R}^{1 \times d}$, but in this work, we will take the **averaged** token representation.

Instead of using `AutoModelForSequenceClassification`, we now use the base `AutoModel` class to tailor the model to our needs. But don't worry, a skeleton code is provided to you in `classification.py`, you would only need to modify the details.

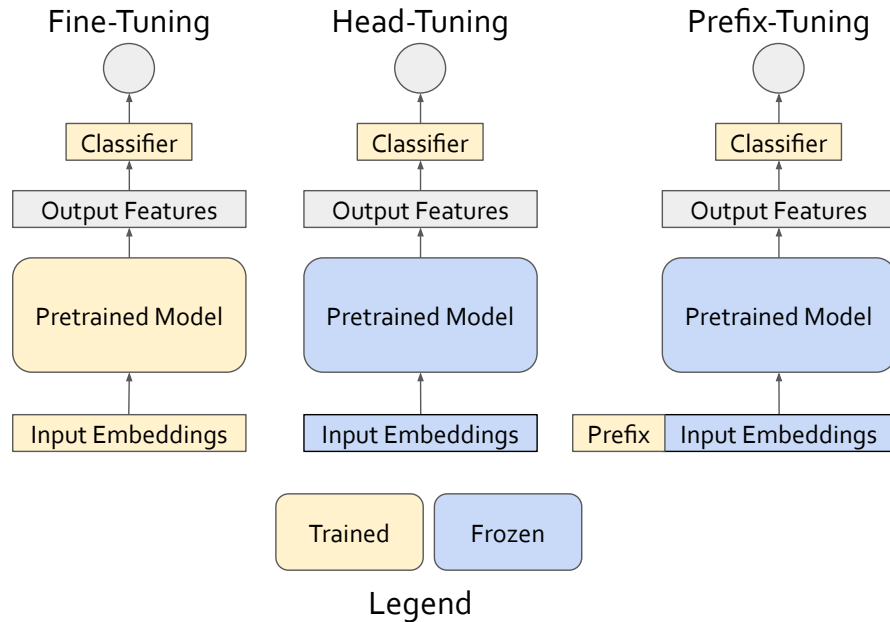


Figure 1: Overview of fine-tuning methods. Blue indicates parts that are frozen (no gradient update) during the fine-tuning process. Yellow indicates parts that are trained (with gradient updates).

- (a) For comparison, let's redo the full finetuning first. Change the base model to RoBERTa-base. Implement full fine-tuning by adding a binary classifier on the averaged sentence representation.

TODOs: Read and complete the missing lines

i. in `evaluate_model` function

ii. after `for index, batch in tqdm(enumerate(train_dataloader)):` in `train` function

in `classification.py` to complete the functionalities of full finetuning.

Hint: Your implementation should be the same as that of `base_classification.py` for `evaluate_model` and almost the same except for how we get the logits for train (until loss backward).

TODOs: Read and complete the missing lines after `if self.type == 'full'` in the forward function of the `CustomModelForSequenceClassification` class in `classification.py`. Run the code with `type="full"` to train the model with full finetuning. Report the final accuracy you obtained along with the hyper-parameters you used (number of epochs and learning rate).

Answer:

dev accuracy:

test accuracy:

epochs:

learning rate:

- (b) **TODOs:** Write down the number of tuned parameters for head-tuning for BoolQ, given that the model hidden size is d .

Answer: *Trainable Parameters* $d \times 2$

Now let's implement head-tuning by adding a binary classifier on the averaged sentence representation.

TODOs: Read and complete the missing lines after `if self.type == 'head'` in the forward function of the `CustomModelForSequenceClassification` class in `classification.py`. You would also need to modify the optimizer by adding code after `my_model.type == 'head':` in the `train` function in `classification.py`. Report the final accuracy on full head-tuning along with the hyper-parameters you used[§].

[§]You would be only graded by the correctness of your implementation, but if you want good performance, Try using a larger learning rate and longer training epochs.

Answer:
dev accuracy:
test accuracy:
epochs:
learning rate:

- (c) **TODOs:** Write down the number of tuned parameters for our prefix-tuning on BoolQ that appends trainable prefix embeddings of length 128, given the model hidden size is d .

Answer: *Trainable Parameters* $d \times 2 + 128 \times d$

It's time to implement prefix tuning!

TODOs: Read and complete the missing lines after `if self.type == 'prefix'` in the forward function of the `CustomModelForSequenceClassification` class in `classification.py`. You would also need to modify the optimizer by adding code after `mymodel.type == "prefix":` in the `train` function in `classification.py`. Report the final accuracy of prefix-tuning along with the hyper-parameters you used [¶].

Answer:
dev accuracy:
test accuracy:
epochs:
learning rate:

- (d) **Extra Credit:** Here is a simple [tutorial](#) on how to use `torch.profile` to record the memory usage of forward and backward operations.

TODOs Generate a bar plot of the forward/backward memory usage of full-finetuning, head-tuning, and prefix-tuning. Note that you don't need to upload any code for this.

your plot

- (e) **LoRA** fine-tuning [[Hu et al., 2022](#)] decomposes the parameter updates of a large dense matrix to two low-rank matrices. For a matrix M of size $\mathbb{R}^{d \times d}$, the full updates require storing the gradients and optimizer states of $d \times d$ parameters.

TODOs: However, if we decompose the gradient update on the full matrix $\Delta M \approx AB$ where $A \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times r}$ and $B \in \mathbb{R}^{r \times d}$, where the rank $r \ll d$. Write down the number of parameters that we update in LoRA fine-tuning.

Answer: $d \times 2n$.

- (f) **Extra Credit:** Implement **LoRA** fine-tuning.

TODOs: Create `classification_lora.py` and copy `classification_base.py` to it and implement the LoRA fine-tuning method using the `peft` library. This should be just changing a few lines of code. Report the trainable parameters and final accuracy of your LoRA fine-tuning, as well as your hyper-parameters.

Answer:
dev accuracy:
test accuracy:
epochs:
learning rate:

3.3 In-Context Learning

- (a) Here we will prompt language models.[¶] You should [sign up for the OpenAI API](#), which lets you use GPT-3 a large, neural language model like the ones that we learned about in lecture.

[¶]Again, you would be only graded by the correctness of your implementation, but if you want good performance, Try using a larger learning rate and longer training epochs.

^{¶¶}Question credit: Chris Callison-Burch's AI course at UPenn.

The OpenAI API is a paid service. OpenAI will give you a few dollars in credit when you first create your account (See the [usage](#) page). For this assignment, the cost should be less than that. For the first part of the assignment, we will get warmed up by playing with the OpenAI API via its [interactive Playground website](#). Later we will see how to integrate it directly into our code.

OpenAI OpenAI products offer a wide spectrum of [capabilities and modes of interaction](#) with their models. For this homework, **we use the Chat mode for both playground and API calls**. In the future, you can explore other modes that might be more up-to-date and powerful, e.g. Assistants ([Playground, APIs](#)), and many more!

Note: we suggest you prioritize your credit usage on finishing this homework question with Chat before exploring other modes, as querying powerful models might be more expensive.

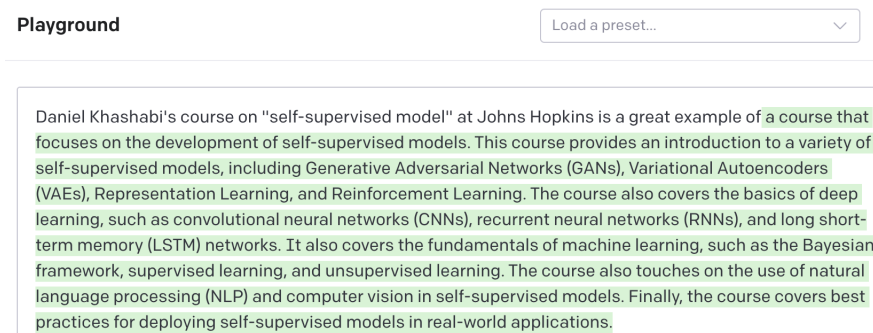
First, let us learn some basic terminology:

- Prompt: the input to the model
- Completion: what the model outputs

Let us try it out.

TODOs: Paste this prompt into the playground, press the “Run” button, and see what it says. Paste a screenshot of the completion below:

Daniel Khashabi's course on "self-supervised model" at Johns Hopkins is a great example of your plot



Now save its output for the end of the semester for your course reviews ... just kidding!!

(b) There are several controls on the right hand side of the playground. These are:

- **Model:** GPT models come in several different sizes and capabilities. You can read more documentation on these models [here](#). For our homework, we use the gpt-4-turbo model.
- **Temperature and Top P sampling:** control how the model samples tokens from its distribution. Setting Temperature to 0 will cause the model to produce the highest probability output. Setting it closer to 1 will increase its propensity to create more diverse output.
- **Maximum length:** what is the maximum length (in tokens) that the model will output?
- **Stop sequences:** you can specify what tokens should cause the model to stop generating. You can use the newline character or any special sequence that you designate.
- **Frequency Penalty and Presence Penalty:** two parameters that help to limit how much repetition there is in the output.
- **Best of:** Best of n indicates the model generate n completion candidates on the server side, and display the top-1 on the client (user) side.

For the remaining parts of this section, set the engine to davinci so that it uses vanilla language model (no additional tuning with human feedback).

In-context learning: In addition to writing awesome reviews of your professors, you can design prompts to get GPT-3 to do all sorts of surprising things. For instance, GPT-3 can perform few-shot learning. Given a few examples of a task, it can learn a pattern very quickly and then be used for classification tasks. It often helps to tell the model what you want it to do.

Here is an example from the paper that introduced GPT-3. It shows a few-shot learning example for correcting grammatically incorrect English sentences.

Poor English input: I eated the purple berries.
Good English output: I ate the purple berries.

Poor English input: Thank you for picking me as your designer. IãŹd appreciate it.
Good English output: Thank you for choosing me as your designer. I appreciate it.

Poor English input: The mentioned changes have done. or I did the alteration that you requested. or I changed things you wanted and did the modifications.
Good English output: The requested changes have been made. or I made the alteration that you requested. or I changed things you wanted and made the modifications.

Poor English input: I would be more than happy to work with you in another project.

TODOs: Paste this prompt into the playground, press the “Generate” button, and see what it says. Paste the completion below:

- (c) **Instruction following:** In addition to few-shot learning, GPT and other large language models do a pretty remarkable job in “zero-shot” scenarios. You can give them instructions in natural language and they may produce remarkably good output.

For example, let us try the following prompt:

Correct this English text: Today I have went to the store to to buys some many bottle of water.

TODOs: Paste this prompt into the playground, press the “Generate” button, and see what it says. Paste the completion below:

Answer:

- (d) **Programmatic access:** In addition to prompting GPT models in the playground, you can write Python code to query models with provided OpenAI APIs. Now let’s use few-shot prompting to solve a few instance of BoolQ.

TODOs: Write a Python script for few-shot prompting OpenAI GPT models on BoolQ. Specifically, form a prompt by randomly selecting 8 demonstrations from BoolQ. Make sure to have a balanced prompt (50% ‘yes’s and the rest ‘no’s) and interleave them to prevent the recency and label-imbalance biases. Using this in-context demonstration, evaluate gpt-3.5-turbo-instruct on a small subset of BoolQ instances (say, 30 examples). Hand in your code used to perform this evaluation, it should be named as openai_gpt-boolq.py. Write down the evaluation accuracy below.

Hints:

- We use the gpt-4-turbo model (model="gpt-4-turbo")
- You can use the playground to create a skeleton code to start with based on a prompt that you can then use in your Python projects. Click on the “View Code” button on the top-right, and you will get some code that you can convert into a script.
- You can also refer to the full documentation for [creating completion](#) and <https://platform.openai.com/docs/api-reference/completions/object>.
- Using OpenAI API requests an API key. You can generate a key associated with your account [here](#). To input the key, you can either do `export OPENAI_API_KEY=<your key>` on Rockfish before running the script (if you are running it on Rockfish). Or refer to the [documentation](#).

Optional Feedback

Have feedback for this assignment? Found something confusing? We would love to hear from you!

References

- Christopher Clark, Kenton Lee, Ming-Wei Chang, Tom Kwiatkowski, Michael Collins, and Kristina Toutanova. Boolq: Exploring the surprising difficulty of natural yes/no questions. In *Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL)*, 2019. URL <https://arxiv.org/pdf/1905.10044.pdf>.
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- Edward J Hu, yelong shen, Phillip Wallis, Zeyuan Allen-Zhu, Yuanzhi Li, Shean Wang, Lu Wang, and Weizhu Chen. LoRA: Low-rank adaptation of large language models. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2022. URL <https://openreview.net/forum?id=nZeVKeeFYf9>.